

TV HIGHLIGHTS

Olympics: Women's hockey, US-Finland, 10:40 a.m., USA
Olympics: Figure skating (team), men's short, 1:45 p.m., NBC
NBA: Rockets-Thunder, 3:30 p.m., ABC
Men's college basketball: Duke-North Carolina, 6:30 p.m., ESPN
NBA: Warriors-Lakers, 8:30 p.m., ABC
Listings, C4, C7

Sports

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THE BOSTON GLOBE SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 7, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS



SUPER BOWL LX PATRIOTS VS. SEAHAWKS Sunday, 6:30 p.m., NBC, Peacock, Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara, Calif.



CHAD FINN

What history will repeat in Bowl No. 12?



SAN FRANCISCO — A funny thing happens when a football franchise makes a habit over a generation or two of appearing in Super Bowls: It's almost inevitable that history will repeat itself in one way or another.

When the Patriots take the field Sunday night against the Seahawks, it will mark the 12th Super Bowl appearance in franchise history and the 10th this century.

It's impossible to project how the game might play out. But it's a near certainty that some pivotal plot twist will remind us of something that has occurred in the franchise's six Super Bowl victories or, yes, their five losses.

With that in mind, let's take a glance back at the Patriots' previous Super Bowls, and consider which flickers of history may recur . . .

Super Bowl XX: Bears 46, Patriots 10. Richard Dent is in the Pro Football Hall of Fame in part due to his dominating performance (two forced fumbles, 1½ sacks, a de-

FINN, Page C2



CHARLIE RIEDEL/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Patriots quarterback Drake Maye was a full participant in practice Friday and is off the injury report for Sunday's Super Bowl against the Seahawks.

CHRISTOPHER L. GASPER

Playoff Maye won't cut it come Sunday



SAN FRANCISCO — Drake Maye will try to summit pro football's highest peak, a confetti-capped crest no quarterback so young has ever ascended. To reach it against the Seahawks, he'll have to summon the peak quarterback play he displayed during a revelatory regular season.

Like a hopeful MBTA passenger, the Patriots are waiting for peak Maye this postseason. History is against the Patriots capping this storybook season by lifting the Lombardi Trophy without one signature performance from their precocious 23-year-old. No quarterback has won four games in a single postseason while failing to complete 60 percent of his passes in any of them.

Maye needs a big game in the Big Game. It's Drake, not Ann Michael Maye, who needs to cook on Sunday at Levi's Stadium, 25 miles from where Tom Brady grew up. Super Bowl LX must serve as the Maye Event, balky right throwing shoulder be darned. (More on the arm alarm

GASPER, Page C3

MORE SUPER BOWL

Bobo bigger than ball

Fan favorite Seahawks receiver far more than meets the football eye. **A1**

Legacy builder

What Stefon Diggs does Sunday could impact his Canton credentials. **C2**

No one like Vrabel

Among one-year coaching turnarounds, this Patriots' one may top them all. **C3**

Backlash brings change

Hall of Fame says tweaks likely to process that denied Belichick, Kraft. **C3**

THE 2026 WINTER OLYMPICS



WANG ZHAO/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Czech flag bearer and Bruins center David Pastrnak led his nation's athletes into Milan's San Siro Stadium on Friday.

United front

Opening Ceremony brings 93 countries on world stage

By Matt Porter
GLOBE STAFF

MILAN — The 25th Winter Olympics began Friday in Northern Italy, with a theme of *Armonia*, the Italian word for harmony.

The day was harmonious indeed, from the rain that mercifully lapsed to the cheering for almost all of the 93 countries who marched.

While the Games' competitive charter prohibits political statements on the field of play, fans made them inside the 75,000-seat San Siro Stadium.

Underneath the golden, illuminated Olympic rings, they sent a rumble of boos over pulsing dance music when Israel's athletes walked the round stage. The Ukrainians were cheered on sight, before the country's name was announced.

The United States heard similar support, American representation clearly strong in the stands. No doubt, the athletes were supported. Vice President JD Vance, however, was vigorously jeered when he and his wife, Usha, were briefly shown on the video board.

Those moments washed away in a sea of

MORE WINTER OLYMPICS

An immersive experience

Cigarettes, tiny screens, Mariah Carey, and DJ Mace among Ceremony reflections. **C5**

Vonn simply undeterred

Despite ruptured ACL, American skiing icon rips through downhill practice. **C5**

Men ready to fly

World's best male downhillers ready for a familiar test on the Stelvio slope. **C4**

Olympic spirit.

"In a time where the world is divided by conflict," Giovanni Malagò, president of the Italian Olympic Committee, said in his closing address to the athletes sitting nearby, "your presence demonstrates that another world is possible."

Kirsty Coventry, the Zimbabwean Olympian and current IOC president, referenced *ubuntu* in her remarks: I am, because we are.

The crowd chanted the name of Italian president Sergio Mattarella before his remarks. Then, famed tenor Andrea Bocelli

sang Giacomo Puccini's "Nessun Dorma" as the Olympic flame passed through the stadium.

Charlize Theron, the South African-American actress, delivered the words of Nelson Mandela: "Peace is not just the absence of conflict; peace is the creation of an environment where all can flourish."

There was no ceremonial torch-lighting inside San Siro.

Italian skiing legends Alberto Tomba and Deborah Compagnoni lit the cauldron at Milan's Arco della Pace. Sofia Goggin, who will race in the women's downhill on Sunday, lit the cauldron in Cortina d'Ampezzo.

Yes, multiple Olympic flames.

The next 16 days aim to unite nations in the spirit of competition, as the Olympics always strive to do. These Games also will merge the city with the mountains, across a distance of some 250 miles. Never before have the Olympics been set up this way, but it could become familiar. Host cities may become host regions to share the Games' massive financial and facility burden.

This was Italy's first *Cerimonia di Aper-*

OPENING CEREMONY, Page C5

Stevens explains moves at deadline

No pressure on Tatum to get back on the floor as he rehabs Achilles

By Adam Himmelsbach
GLOBE STAFF

Celtics president of basketball operations Brad Stevens on Friday discussed the team's trade deadline approach, Jayson Tatum's recovery, and other matters. Here are the highlights:

■ The Celtics' most significant move prior to Thursday's trade deadline came Tuesday, when they agreed to send guard Anfernee Simons to the Bulls in exchange for center Nikola Vucevic.

Stevens said the Celtics made that move, in large part, to balance out their positional alignment. It became clear there wasn't reliable depth behind centers Neemias Queta and Luka Garza.

"And Nikola is a good player," Stevens said. "He's been a good player for a long time. Obviously, the shooting and scoring get a lot of attention. The passing is a big factor for us, and it's something we really like in bigs."

"So, it's just something that gives us another look, and I think our two guys that have played the majority of the minutes at that position have been outstanding, so we're excited to have all three of them and see

how it all fits together."

Vucevic, 35, is averaging 16.9 points and 9 rebounds while shooting 37.6 percent from the 3-point line. He entered Friday night's contest against the Heat 3:02 in, after Queta picked up two early fouls.

■ The Celtics on Thursday also traded end-of-bench players Josh Minott, Chris Boucher, and Xavier Tillman, while receiving only two-way-contract player John Tonje in return. Boston converted center Amari Williams's two-way contract to a standard NBA deal, but that still left the team with three empty roster spots. The Celtics will have to fill two within the next two weeks to get their roster to the league minimum of 14 players.

Stevens said the Celtics "feel really good" about two-way-contract players Tonje, Ron Harper Jr., and Max Shulga. Harper thrived in a starting role in the upset win over the Rockets on Wednesday, and Stevens seemed to hint that these players will have opportunities to earn promotions.

"With that said, I think the biggest thing is seeing how this

STEVENS, Page C6



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

MORE THAN WELCOME — Nikola Vucevic's first basket as a Celtic came over Bam Adebayo, part of an uplifting victory in which Boston came from 22 down to beat Miami. Story, C6

INSIDE

Money matters

Foxborough threatens to withhold World Cup license if it doesn't get security funds. **C4**

Why no Crochet?

Usage, fatherhood led Red Sox ace to pass on Team USA, World Baseball Classic. **C4**